

Yee Man (Kath) Choi

PHD STUDENT · DAVID R. CHERITON SCHOOL OF COMPUTER SCIENCE

University of Waterloo, 200 University Ave W, Waterloo, ON N2L 3G1, Canada

✉ ymchoi@uwaterloo.ca | 🏠 <https://kathcym.github.io/> | 🐦 @yeemanchoi

Education

University of Waterloo

PHD COMPUTER SCIENCE

- Advisor: Dr. Freda Shi, Dr. Krzysztof Czarnecki

Waterloo, ON, Canada

Sep 2025 - present,

Language Technologies Institute - Carnegie Mellon University

MS COMPUTATIONAL DATA SCIENCE (MAJOR IN ANALYTICS TRACK)

- Advisor: Dr. Lei Li

Pittsburgh, PA, United States

Aug 2023 - Dec 2024

University of Toronto - St. George Campus

BASc COMPUTER ENGINEERING (MINORS IN ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE)

- Undergrad Thesis: Identify Subsets of Bugs in Mozilla Dataset of interest for Machine Learning
- Advisor: Dr. Shurui Zhou, Dr. David Lie

Toronto, ON, Canada

Sep 2017 - May 2022

Research Interests

- Large Language Models, Alignment & Security, AI Governance, Code Generation, Computational Linguistics, AI4Research

Professional Experience

2024-2025 **Graduate Research Assistant**, Carnegie Mellon University

Full-time position, worked on code generation project (HardTests) under the supervision of Prof. Lei Li

2022-2023 **Software Development Engineer (Full-time)**, Amazon

Full-time position, initialized and built the False-positive deployment detection mechanism, to detect short-lived deployment issues, hence preventing false passes in approval workflow for pre-production environments

2021 **Software Development Engineer Intern**, Amazon

3-months internship, trained models with over 95% accuracy for predicting the performance of advertisement keywords and created an API to expose data sources of keyword recommendations for performance analysis

2020-2021 **Digital Design & Verification Engineer**, Rambus

12-months internship, Worked on automating the workflow of design specifications and timing constraints verification for new serializer/deserializer (SerDes)

2019 **Undergraduate Research Assistant**, LegUp, University of Toronto

Summer Research Student, Worked on dynamic memory allocation with High-Level Synthesis for Field Programmable Gate Arrays (FPGAs) under the supervision of Prof. Jason Anderson

2018 **Lab Programmer**, Finn LAND Lab, University of Toronto

Part-time Work Study program, Worked on designing experiments, database management, and analysis on f-MRI imaging data, under the supervision of Prof. Amy Finn

Publications

Yee Man Choi, Abdul B Ali, Krzysztof Czarnecki, Freda Shi

The Illusion of Choice: Assessing Impact of Manipulated LLMs.

ICML 2026 Second Workshop on Technical AI Governance Research

Yee Man Choi, Xuehang Guo, Yi R. (May) Fung, Qingyun Wang

CiteGuard: Faithful Citation Attribution for LLMs via Retrieval-Augmented Validation.

Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026 Oral presentation

Zhongmou He*, **Yee Man Choi***, Kexun Zhang*, Jiabao Ji, Junting Zhou, Dejia Xu, Ivan Bercovich, Aidan Zhang, Lei Li
HARDTESTGEN: A High-Quality RL Verifier Generation Pipeline for LLM Algorithmic Coding.
 The Fourteenth International Conference on Learning Representations, NeurIPS 2025 Deep Learning for Code Workshop (DL4C) * denotes equal contribution

Kexun Zhang, **Yee Man Choi**, Zhenqiao Song, Taiqi He, William Yang Wang, Lei Li
Hire a Linguist!: Learning Endangered Languages with In-Context Linguistic Descriptions.
 Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2024

Yee Man Choi, Xuehang Guo, Songcheng Cai, Yimu Wang, Yi R. Fung, Qingyun Wang
ATTRICITE: Training an Open 4B Model for Citation Recovery toward Faithful Attribution
 Preprint

Yimu Wang, **Yee Man Choi**, Barry Zhang, Mozghan Nasr Azadani, Sean Sedwards, Krzysztof Czarnecki
Where Does the Answer Come From? Benchmarking View-Level Visual Evidence Identification in Multi-View MLLMs for Autonomous Driving
 Preprint

Xuye Liu, Yimu Wang, Peng Shi, Bo Xue, Xiangrui Ke, Songcheng Cai, **Kath Choi**, Di Wu, Freda Shi, Krzysztof Czarnecki
LitTraceQA: A Benchmark for Multi-Stage Grounding and Verification in Scientific Question Answering
 Preprint

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2026	Ontario Graduate Scholarship , Government of Ontario	\$ 15,000
2026	President's Graduate Scholarship , University of Waterloo	\$ 5,000
2026	Graduate Student Research Dissemination Award , University of Waterloo	\$ 500
2026	WiCS Graduate Student Scholarship , University of Waterloo	\$ 3000
2025	Cohere Graduate Scholarship in Computer Science , University of Waterloo	\$ 10,000
2025	Vector Institute Research Grant , Vector Institute	\$ 6,000
2025	David R. Cheriton Graduate Scholarship , University of Waterloo	\$ 20,000
2025	Provost Doctoral Entrance Award for Women , University of Waterloo	\$ 5,000
2017-2022	Dean's List Scholar , University of Toronto	
2018	Shou-yun Pang Scholarship , University of Toronto	\$ 4,500
2017	Kowk Ming King Scholarship , University of Toronto	\$ 260,000

Service and Outreach

2026	NeurIPS 2026 2nd Workshop on VLM4RWD: Grounded and Faithful Vision-Language Models for Real-World Deployment 2026 , Area Chair	<i>Sydney</i>
2026	EMNLP 2026 1ts Workshop on Grounding Language Models: Learning Faithfully and Efficiently , Organizing Committee, Program Chair	<i>Budapest</i>
2018	Google igniteCS Program , Volunteer Instructor	<i>Toronto</i>

Teaching Experience

Fall '2026	CS 234 Data Types and Structures , Teaching Assistant	<i>UWaterloo</i>
Sum '2026	CS 247 Software Engineering Principles , Teaching Assistant	<i>UWaterloo</i>
Wint '2026	CS 489/698 Introduction to Natural Language Processing , Teaching Assistant	<i>UWaterloo</i>
Wint '2026	CS 241 Foundations of Sequential Programs , Teaching Assistant	<i>UWaterloo</i>
Fall '2025	CS 246 Object-Oriented Software Development , Teaching Assistant	<i>UWaterloo</i>
Spr '2025	11868 Large Language Model Systems , Head Teaching Assistant	<i>CMU</i>

Other Relevant Research/Projects

Mechanism Design with Large Language Models

COLLABORATION WITH JIAYUAN LIU

Sep - Dec 2024

- Formulated mechanism design as a code generation task.
- Leveraged LLMs capabilities and evolution methods for better mechanism design.

Model-Based Evaluation for Code Summarization

COLLABORATION WITH ALEX XIE, BRIAN TUFTS AND DIVYANSHU SHETH

Jan - May, 2024

- Demonstrated the limitation of current n-gram based evaluation metrics for code summarization task
- Proposed execution-based, model-based evaluation, and Minimum Bayes Risk(MBR) Quality Estimation as new metrics

Developing Chatbot Personalities by Adjusting its tone of voice

ADVISED BY PROF. BAOCHUN LI, COLLABORATION WITH SOPHIE MAO AND TINA YANG

Sep 2021 - May 2022

- Trained text style transfer model using back-translation, to output different tones of speech as requested

Photo2Impressionism

COLLABORATION WITH SOPHIE MAO AND TINA YANG

Sep - Dec 2021

- Collected paintings from the impressionism style with filtering to remove sketches and keep only paintings
- Trained a model with CycleGAN to do the style transfer

Skills

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES

- C, C++, Python, Rust, Java, CUDA

TOOLS AND FRAMEWORKS

- Pytorch, DeepSpeed, Git, Vim, Bash, SSH

LANGUAGES

- Cantonese (native), Mandarin(native), English(fluent), Japanese(beginner)